peaceful means. Muslim United Front (MUF) was formed to represent the sentiments of Kashmiri Muslims for the final settlement of the Kashmir issue. The administration at Delhi was alarmed by the kind of support that MUF was gaining and as a consequence we saw rigging in the elections on an unprecedented scale, and the leaders who took part in the elections and won with a huge majority were arrested, humiliated and put behind bars. It is only after this that the same leaders gave a call for armed resistance. In response thousands of youth took to armed revolt. I dropped out from my MBBS studies in Jhelum Valley Medical College, Srinagar. I was also one of those who crossed to the other side of Kashmir as a JKLF member, but was disillusioned after seeing Pakistani Politicians acting the same as Indian politicians in dealing with Kashmiris. I returned after few weeks. I surrendered to the security forces—and you know, I was even given a BSF certificate as a surrendered militant. I began a new life. I could not become a doctor but I became a dealer of medicines and surgical instruments on a commission basis! (He laughs.)

With my meagre income I even bought a scooter and also got married. But never a day passed by without the scare of Rashtriya Rifles and STF men harassing me. If there was a militant attack somewhere in Kashmir they would round up civilians, torture them to pulp, but the situation was worse for a surrendered militant like me. They detained us for several weeks, and threatened to implicate us in false cases. We were let free only if we paid huge bribes. I had to go through this kind of treatment many times. Major Ram Mohan Roy of 22 Rashtriya Rifles gave me electric shocks in my private parts. I was made to clean their toilets and sweep their camps. Once I had to bribe the security men with all that I had to escape from the Humhama STF torture camp. DSP Vinay Gupta and DSP Davinder Singh supervised the torture there. One of their torture experts, Inspector Shanty Singh, gave me electric shocks for three hours until I agreed to pay one lakh rupees as bribe. My wife sold her jewellery and my scooter. I left the camp broken both financially and mentally. For six months I could not leave my house because my body was in such a bad shape. I could not even share the bed with my wife as I'd been given electric shocks on my penis. I had to take medical treatment to regain potency . . .

Afzal narrated the torture details with such calm that it was disturbing. Unable to hear about the horrors perpetrated by the security forces that